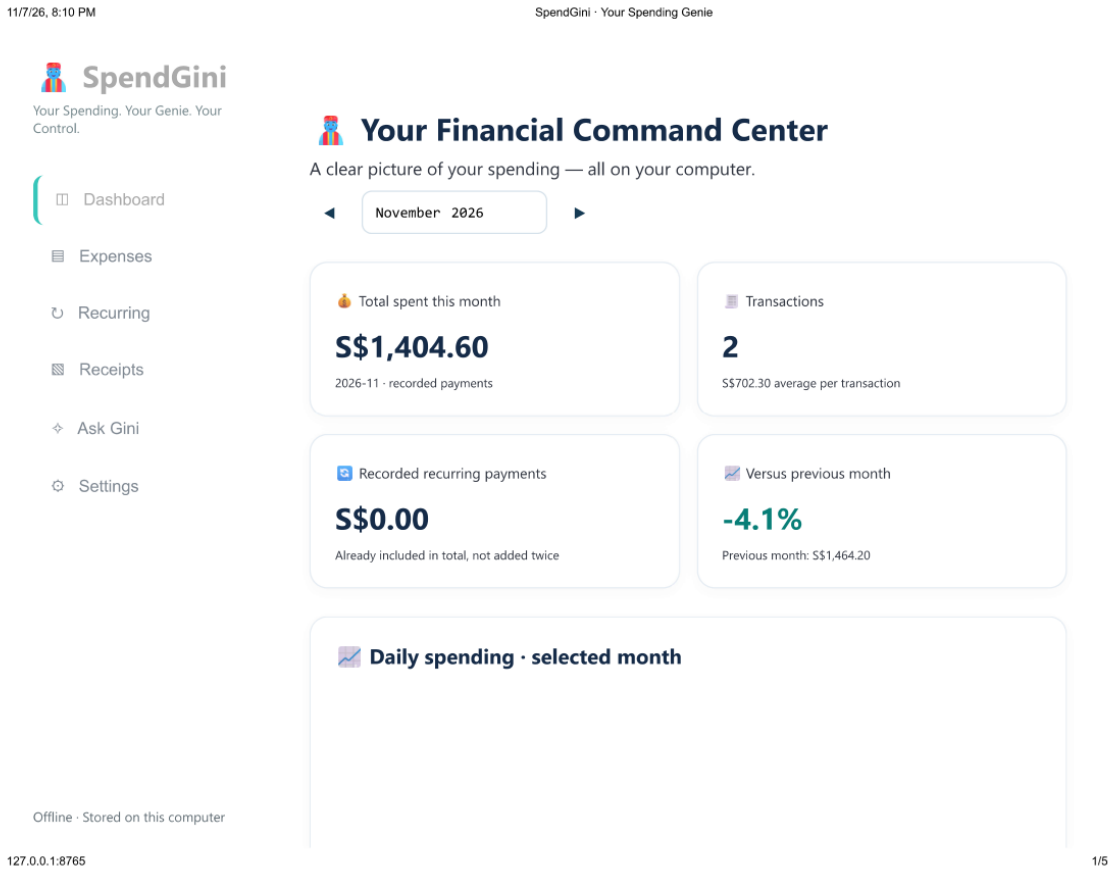
SpendGini

YOUR SPENDING. YOUR GENIE. YOUR CONTROL.

User Manual

A private, local expense tracker for recording transactions, reviewing spending, managing recurring commitments, scanning receipts, and asking questions about saved expenses.



Application reference: Dashboard View — page 1

1 Getting started

What you need

A Windows computer with the SpendGini application available locally. The interface opens in your web browser but communicates with a service on your own computer. Receipt scanning additionally requires the locally installed OCR dependencies, including Tesseract. The application is not a cloud account or online banking integration.

Start and navigate

1. Launch SpendGini using the method provided with your local installation.

2. Open the local application page when it appears in your browser. The implementation uses 127.0.0.1:8765 by default.

3. Choose Dashboard, Expenses, Recurring, Receipts, Ask Gini, or Settings from the left navigation.

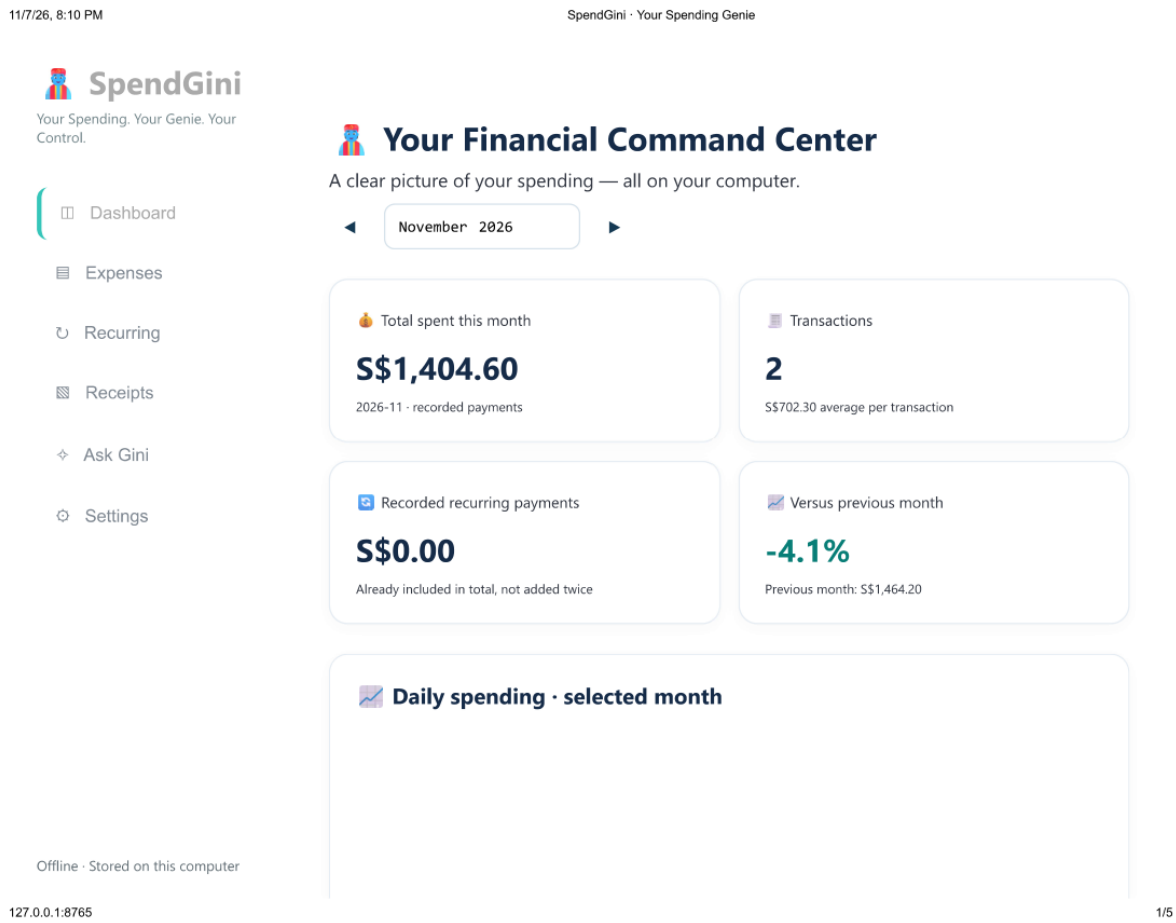
4. Begin by adding an expense so the dashboard and Ask Gini have records to analyze.

Note: This is not an installation guide. Packaging and launch instructions depend on how the private application is distributed.

Navigation at a glance

Dashboard	**Monthly totals, trends, merchant/category breakdowns, and offline insights.**
Expenses	Create, edit, delete, search, filter and sort transactions.
Recurring	Track upcoming monthly, quarterly, and yearly payment schedules.
Receipts	Run local OCR, review suggested fields, and save verified receipts.
Ask Gini	Ask supported questions about recorded transactions.
Settings	Review local storage guidance and export CSV.

2 Dashboard — understand your spending



Application reference: Dashboard View — page 1

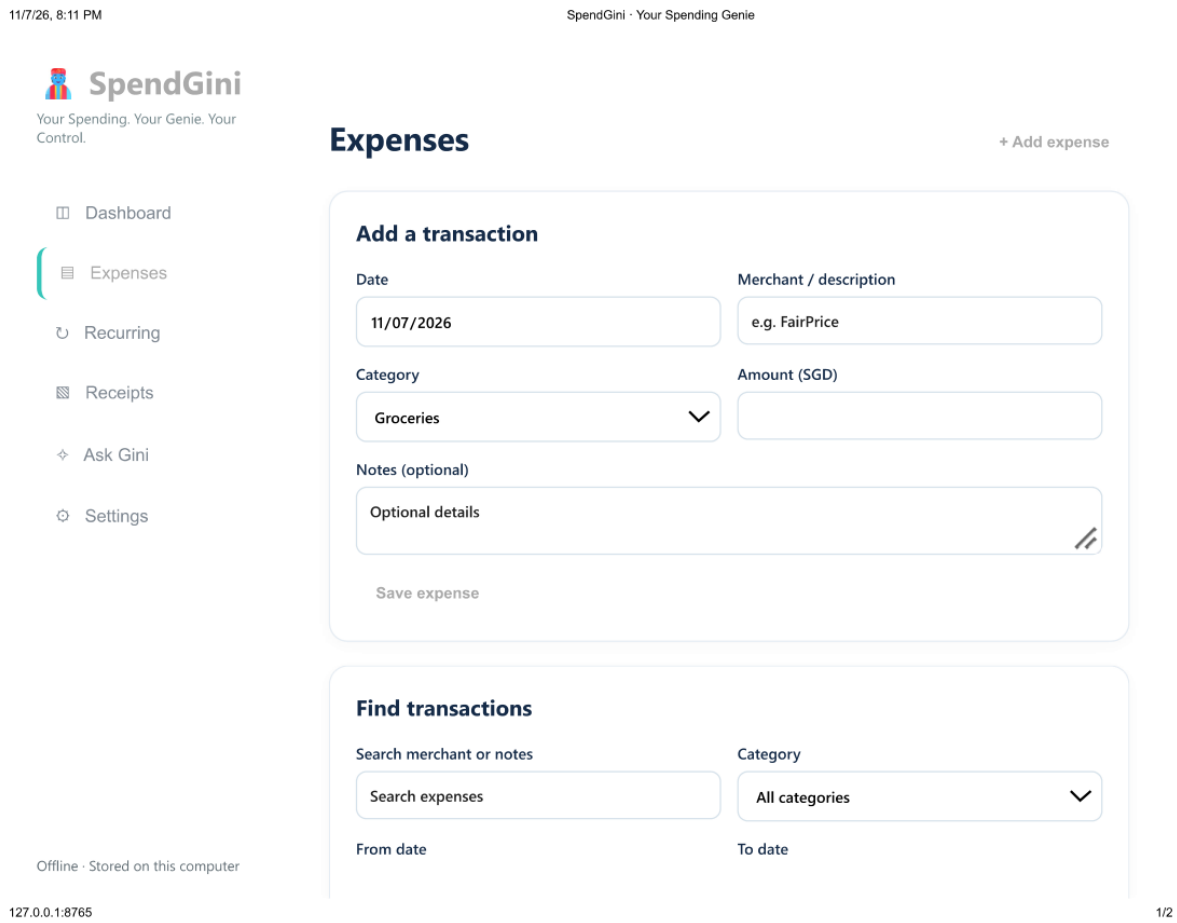
1. Select a month using the month picker or previous/next controls.
2. Review Total spent, Transactions, Recorded recurring payments, and the previous-month comparison.
3. Explore daily spending and the six-month chart. Hover over chart marks for values where supported.
4. Review Spending by category and Top 5 merchants.
5. Read Gini's insight corner, monthly briefing, alerts, savings opportunities and upcoming commitments.

Interpretation: Recorded recurring payments are already included in total spending, not added twice. An unpaid recurring schedule is not an expense. The monthly briefing avoids full-month comparisons when the selected month is incomplete; the headline previous-month indicator may still show a raw comparison, so interpret it carefully.

Smart insights are suggestions, not forecasts

Spending alerts flag unusually large recorded transactions when sufficient data exists. Savings opportunities identify category increases that merit review; they do not guarantee savings. Upcoming commitments reflect saved next-due dates, not verified payment status.

3 Expenses — record and manage transactions



Application reference: Expense View — page 1

Add an expense

1. Open Expenses and locate Add a transaction.
2. Enter the date, merchant/description, category, and positive amount in SGD.
3. Optionally enter notes.
4. Select Save expense and confirm that the transaction appears in All transactions.

Find and review expenses

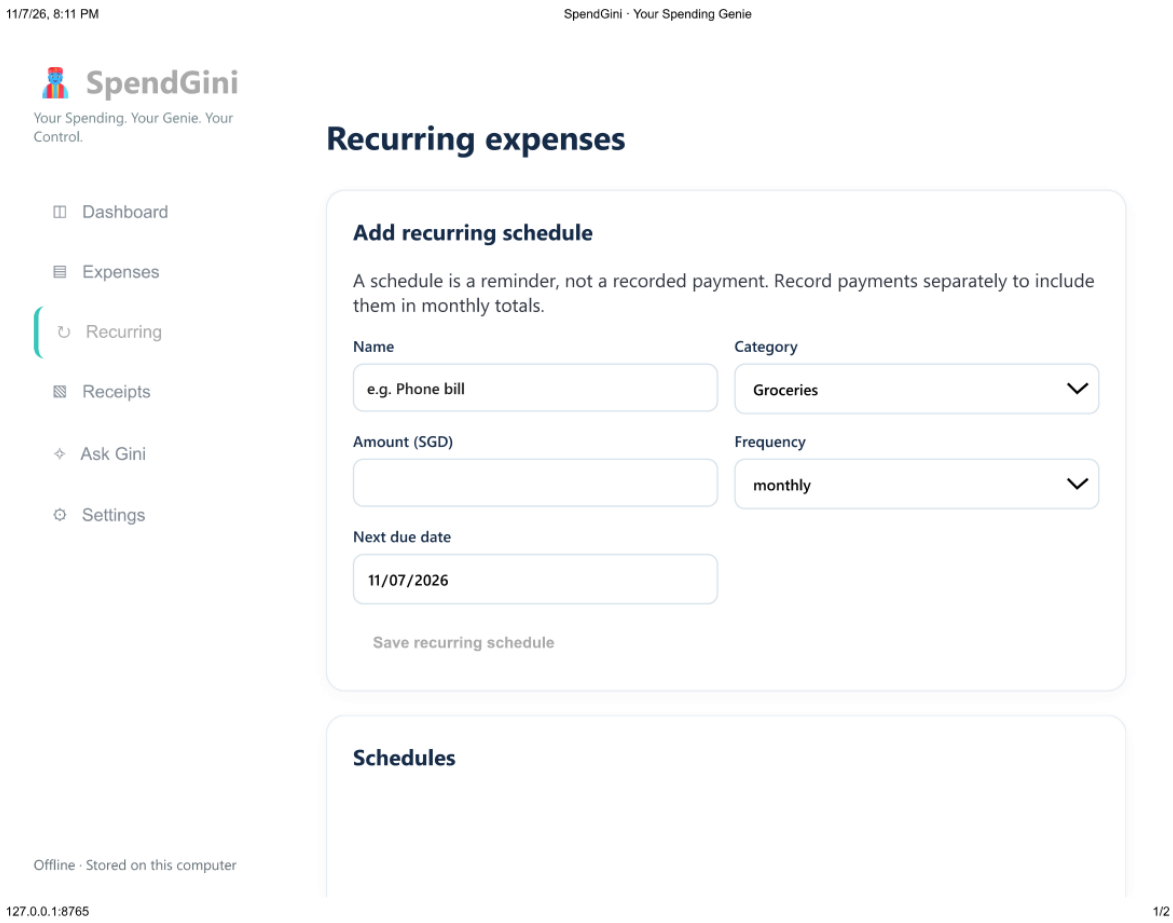
1. Use Search merchant or notes to narrow the list.
2. Optionally select a category, From date, and To date.
3. Sort by newest, oldest, highest amount, or lowest amount.
4. Use Clear filters to restore the full list.

Edit or delete

1. Choose Edit on the relevant transaction, update fields, and select Save changes.
2. To remove a record, choose Delete and confirm the prompt.
3. Recheck the dashboard after a change because totals are calculated from saved records.

Caution: Editing a receipt-linked expense changes its summary but does not automatically recalculate the saved receipt item rows. Check item-level records before making a correction.

4 Recurring — plan commitments



Application reference: Recurring View — page 1

Create a schedule

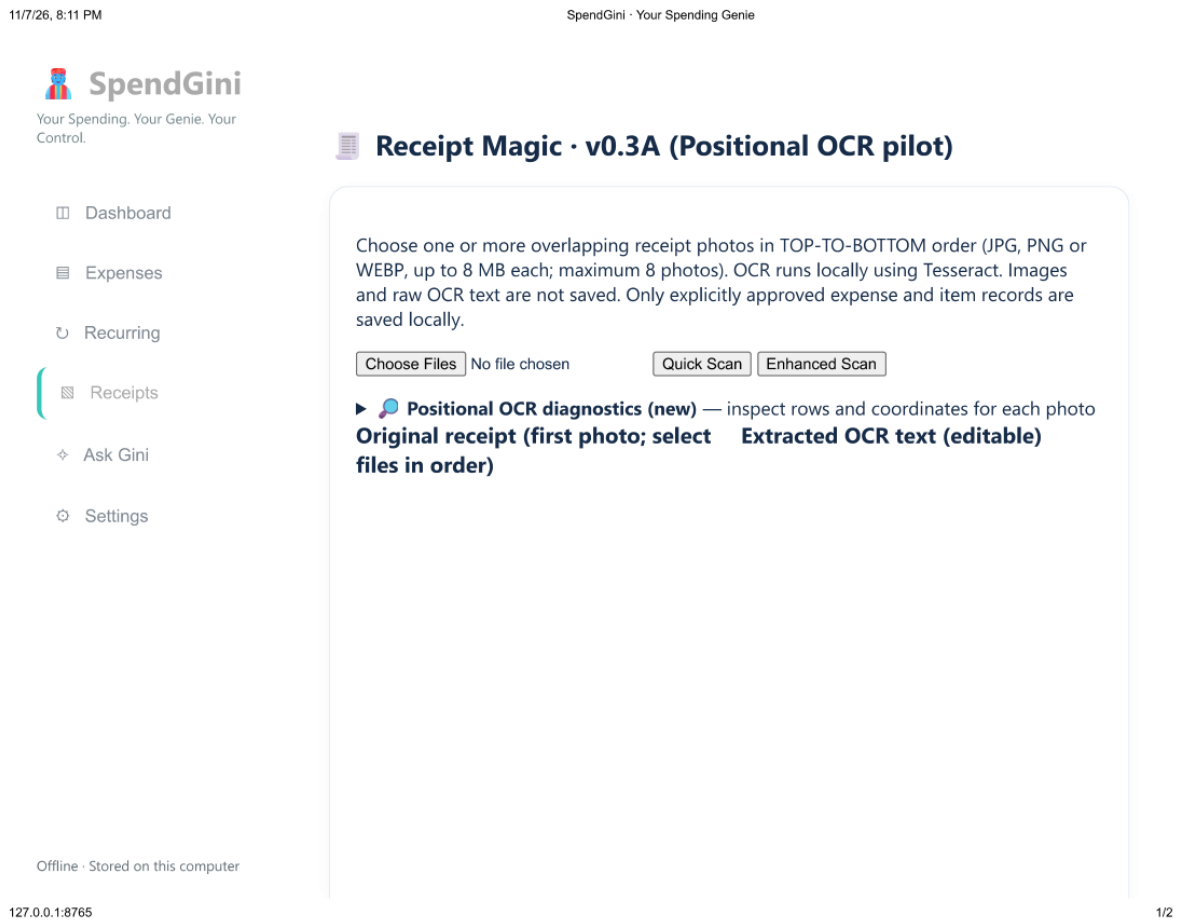
1. Open Recurring and select Add recurring schedule.
2. Enter a name, category, expected amount, and frequency (monthly, quarterly, or yearly).
3. Set the next due date and save the schedule.
4. Review the schedule in the list and on the dashboard's upcoming commitments area.

When a bill is actually paid

1. Go to Expenses and record the payment as a transaction.
2. Do not assume the schedule itself has been recorded as spending.
3. If a schedule is no longer relevant, delete it; existing recorded payments remain.

Important: Schedules are reminders. This version does not automatically record a payment or advance the next due date. The dashboard only counts actual recorded expenses.

5 Receipts — Receipt Magic (OCR pilot)



Application reference: Receipt Scan View — page 1

Receipt Magic v0.3A is an experimental positional-OCR workflow. It can suggest receipt details, but the original image remains the source of truth. Never save unverified OCR values.

Scan one or more photos

1. Open Receipts and select JPG, PNG or WEBP receipt photos. Each file must be 8 MB or smaller; up to eight photos are accepted.
2. For a long receipt, select overlapping photos in top-to-bottom order.
3. Choose Quick Scan for an initial attempt or Enhanced Scan for additional OCR processing.
4. Review the extracted text, the original-photo preview, and positional OCR diagnostics where useful.
5. Select Extract suggested details.

Verify and save

1. Compare merchant, date (DD/MM/YYYY), category and paid total with the original receipt.
2. Inspect every item description, quantity, unit price and line amount; correct errors or add/remove item rows.

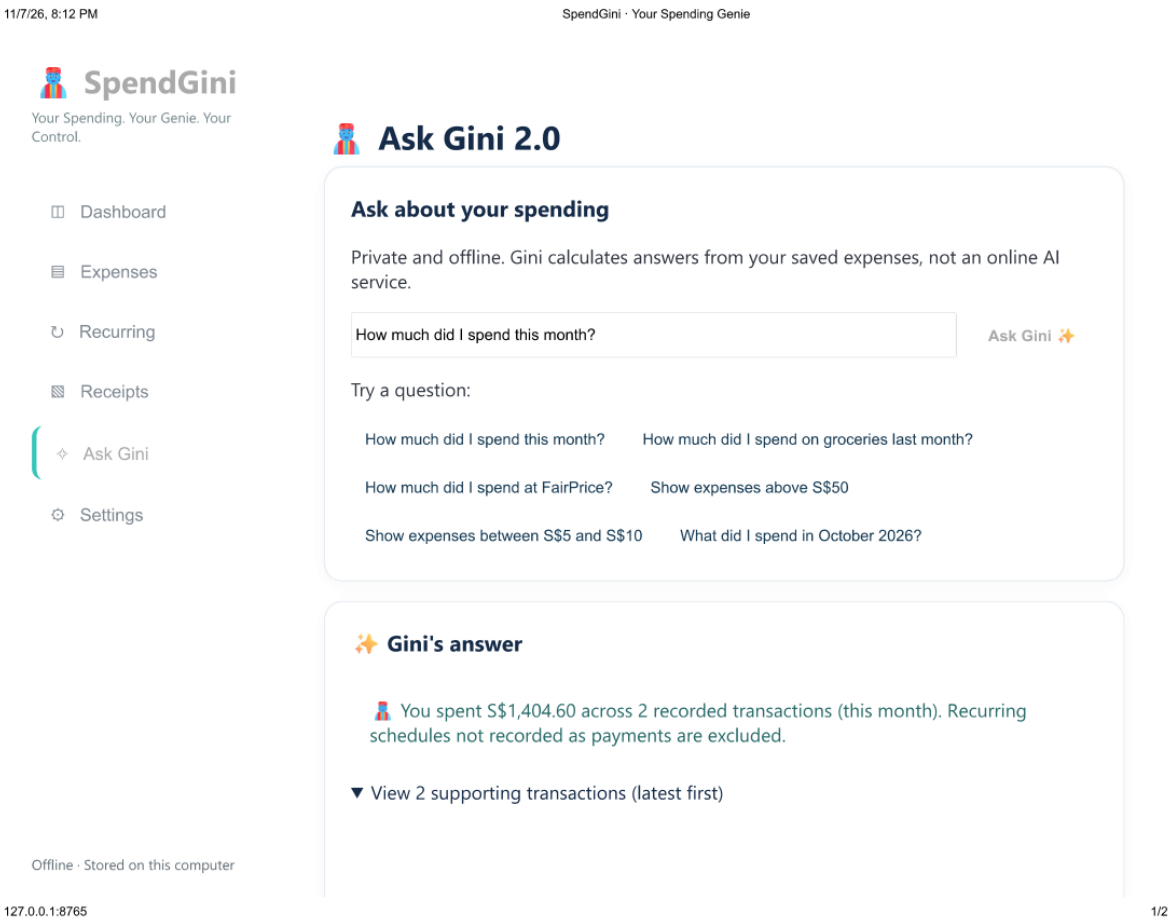
3. Check tax/GST, discount, rounding, and the displayed difference between adjusted subtotal and paid total.

4. Review completeness warnings, photo coverage and confidence indicators; a green status does not prove that every item was captured.

5. Select Save verified receipt only after manually confirming the fields and approving the confirmation prompt.

Receipt photos and raw OCR text are not intended to be retained by this workflow; approved expense and item records are stored locally. Complex, faded, long or multi-photo receipts may be incomplete or inaccurate. Recheck the original photos every time.

6 Ask Gini — query recorded spending



Application reference: Ask Gini View — page 1

Ask Gini is an offline, rule-based natural-language assistant, not a generative AI service. It answers supported questions using your saved transactions and can show supporting transaction evidence.

Ask a question

1. Open Ask Gini.

2. Select a suggested question or type a supported request.

3. Click Ask Gini.

4. Read the answer and expand supporting transactions to verify the result.

Questions to try

Total	**How much did I spend this month?**
Category	How much did I spend on groceries last month?
Merchant	How much did I spend at FairPrice?
Amount filter	Show expenses above S$50
Range	Show expenses between S$5 and S$10
Named month	What did I spend in October 2026?

Supported filters include current/previous month, named months, today/yesterday, known merchants/categories, and basic amount thresholds or ranges. Unsupported requests (such as forecasting, why-questions, or complex comparisons) receive a limitation message. Answers are read-only and exclude unpaid recurring schedules.

7 Settings, export and backup

Export expenses

1. Open Settings.

2. Select Export expenses to CSV.

3. Save the downloaded file in a secure location.

4. Open it in a spreadsheet application if you want to review or analyze the records outside SpendGini.

Back up your local data

1. Close SpendGini before making a backup.

2. Find the SpendGini folder in your Windows user home directory; the default database is SpendGini/spendgini.db.

3. Copy the complete folder to a secure external drive or other storage you control.

4. Keep backup copies protected; the application database is not encrypted by SpendGini.

The application listens on the loopback address 127.0.0.1 and does not require an external API for its documented core workflows. Local-only does not mean encrypted: protect the Windows account, device, backups, and exported CSV files.

8 Troubleshooting

Dashboard shows zero	**Confirm you selected the correct month and recorded an expense for that period.**
Expense not found	Clear filters; check date, category, and merchant spelling.
Ask Gini cannot answer	Use a supported total/search question and a merchant or category name from saved transactions.

Receipt scan fails	Check file type/size, local Tesseract installation, and whether OCR dependencies are available.
Receipt totals do not reconcile	Check item rows, tax, discounts and rounding against the original receipt; do not save until verified.
Recurring bill missing from spending	Record the actual payment under Expenses; a schedule is only a reminder.
Application page does not open	Check that the local SpendGini process is running and the configured localhost port is available.

9 Current limitations and responsible use

SpendGini is an active-development local application. Receipt extraction is a pilot and may require extensive manual correction. Ask Gini supports a defined set of query patterns, not unrestricted conversational reasoning. Recurring schedules do not automatically become expenses. Budget planning is deferred. The application does not implement database encryption or password-based access controls; device and backup protection are the user's responsibility.

10 Quick-reference workflow

1. Record everyday spending in Expenses.
2. Add bill and subscription reminders under Recurring.
3. Use Receipts for OCR-assisted entry only when you can verify the original receipt.
4. Review Dashboard each month for categories, merchants and spending patterns.
5. Use Ask Gini for focused questions and inspect supporting records.
6. Export and back up your records periodically.